

Madison Dell

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Research Interests

Economics of education; Postsecondary education policy; Vocational education and training; Experimental and quasi-experimental methods.

Employment

Postdoctoral Researcher, University of Zurich & Swiss Leading House	2025–
Senior Director for Strategic Research Initiatives, Tennessee Board of Regents	2022–2025
Doctoral Student, Stanford University	2019–2023
Research Analyst, Tennessee Higher Education Commission	2016–2019

Education

Ph.D.	Economics of Education , Stanford University	2023
	<i>Dissertation:</i> “ Unlocking opportunity, advancing equity: Improving college outcomes for marginalized students ”	
	<i>Committee:</i> Eric Bettinger (Chair), Thomas S. Dee, Anthony Lising Antonio, Alvin Pearman	
M.A.	Economics , Stanford University	2022
M.A.	Higher Education Administration , Louisiana State University	2015
B.I.S.	Integrated Studies , University of Tennessee at Chattanooga	2014

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- Domingue, B. W., **Dell, M.**, Lang, D., Silverman, R., Yeatman, J., & Hough, H. (2022). The effect of COVID on oral reading fluency during the 2020–2021 academic year. *AERA Open*, 8. <https://doi.org/10.1177/23328584221120254>.
- Collier, D. A., Fitzpatrick, D., **Dell, M.**, Snideman, S. S., Marsicano, C. R., Kelchen, R., & Wells, K. E. (2022). We want you back: Uncovering the influences on in-person instructional operations in fall 2020. *Research in Higher Education*, 63(5), 741–767. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11162-021-09665-5>.
- Lee, J. L., **Dell, M.**, González Canché, M. S., Monday, A., & Klafehn, A. (2021). The hidden costs of corroboration: Estimating the effects of financial aid verification on college enrollment. *Educational Evaluation and Policy Analysis*, 43(2), 233–252. <https://doi.org/10.3102/0162373721989304>.

Book Chapter

- House, E. A. & **Dell, M.** (2020). Keeping the promise: Early outcomes of Tennessee’s tuition-free college initiative. In L. W. Perna & E. J. Smith (Eds.), *Improving Research-Based Knowledge of College Promise Programs* (pp. 151–172). AERA. <https://doi.org/10.2307/j.ctvxw3phv.10>.

Working Papers

- Matheny, K. T., Dell, M., Gluek, G., Baker, R., Bettinger, E., Monday, A., & Mesa, H. (2025). Fast track to success? A mixed methods evaluation of condensed course formats at Tennessee community colleges. <https://edworkingpapers.com/ai26-1346>. *Revise and resubmit, Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*.
- Lehnert, P., Dell, M., Backes-Gellner, U., & Bettinger, E. (2024). The effect of postsecondary educational institutions on local economies: A bird's-eye view. <https://www.nber.org/papers/w32679>.
- Dell, M., Brox, E., Palffy, P., Schilter, C., & Backes-Gellner, U. (2026). Choice architecture in occupational choices. <https://ideas.repec.org/p/iso/educat/0255.html>.
- Dell, M. & Monday, A. (2026). Unequal and persistent effects of student loan policy: Evidence from Parent PLUS reforms. <https://edworkingpapers.com/ai26-1483>.

Work in Progress

- Dell, M., Gluek, G., Matheny, K. T., Baker, R., Bettinger, E., Monday, A., & Mesa, H. *More than a matter of time: Variation in the effects of condensed courses across students, courses, and institutions*.
- Dell, M. & Bettinger, E. *Coaching for college persistence: Experimental and qualitative evidence from a high-touch virtual program*.
- Dell, M., Lee, J. C., & Weeden, D. *Investigating factors associated with college openings and closures: The role of state authorization policies*. Earlier version available [here](#).

Teaching Experience

Adjunct Assistant Professor, Vanderbilt University (**HOD 2500: Systematic Inquiry**), Spring 2025. Instructor of record; 87 undergraduate students; managed 3 teaching assistants; transitioned the course from in-person to hybrid modality.

Teaching Assistant, Stanford University (**PUBLPOL 301B: Economic Policy Analysis for Policymakers**), Spring 2020–2022. 18–24 undergraduate and graduate students; taught weekly discussion sections to provide additional support for students; redesigned the course for online delivery during COVID (2020–2021); resumed in-person instruction in 2022.

Grants, Fellowships, and Honors

Grant

Funder: Ascendium Education Group (\$734,300) 2022–2024
Role: Co-Principal Investigator
Title: Fast track to success? A mixed methods evaluation of condensed course formats

Fellowships

[Stanford Graduate Fellowship in Science and Engineering \(VPGE\)](#) 2021–2024
~50,000/year for 3 years (*Forfeited after securing full-time employment in 2022.*)

[Doctoral Training Program, Quantitative Education Policy Analysis \(IES\)](#) 2019–2021
~30,000/year for 2 years

Honors

AEI Education Policy Academy	2022
SHHEO & Gates Community of Practice: Data Modeling for State Attainment Goals	2018
NCES Data Institute	2018

Invited Seminars (* indicates the presenter/presenters)

- Dell, M.*, Brox, E., Palffy, P., Schilter, C., & Backes-Gellner, U. (2026, May 11). *Choice architecture in occupational choices*. Paper presented at the [Seminar of Economics and Management \(SEAM\)](#) at Paderborn University.
- Lehnert, P.*, Dell, M., Backes-Gellner, U., & Bettinger, E. (2025, May 6). *The effect of postsecondary institutions on local economies: A bird's-eye view*. Paper presented at the [PRICE Seminar](#) at ZEW Mannheim.
- Lehnert, P.*, Dell, M., Backes-Gellner, U., & Bettinger, E. (2024, April 30). *The effect of postsecondary institutions on local economies: A bird's-eye view*. Paper presented at the [Regional Disparities and Economic Policy Seminar](#) at Duisburg-Essen University.
- Lehnert, P., Dell, M., Backes-Gellner, U., & Bettinger, E.* (2023, November 1). *The effect of postsecondary institutions on local economies: A bird's-eye view*. Paper presented at the [Hoover Institution's Economic Policy Working Group](#) at Stanford University.
- Lehnert, P., Dell, M., Backes-Gellner, U., & Bettinger, E.* (2022, February 17). *The effect of postsecondary institutions on local economies: A bird's-eye view*. Paper presented at the Swiss Leading House's [Friday Lunch Talk Series](#) at the University of Zurich.

Guest Lectures (* indicates the presenter/presenters)

- Dell, M.* (2025, February 27). *The Tennessee Coaching Project*. Guest lecture delivered in Dr. Cara DeLoach's Research in Human Development (HDS 7810) class at Vanderbilt University.
- DeLoach, C.* & Dell, M.* (2025, January 21). *Pathways to transfer & community college student success*. Guest lecture delivered in Dr. Emily House's Community Colleges, Credentialing, and Vocationalism in Higher Education (HEA 6220) class at Vanderbilt University.
- Dell, M.* (2024, October 14). *An introduction to the Tennessee Coaching Project*. Guest lecture delivered in Dr. Christine Dickason's Qualitative Research Methods (EDUC 8122) class at George Washington University.
- Dell, M.* (2024, February 23). *Strategic research initiatives at TBR: Accelerated courses and the Coaching Project*. Guest lecture delivered in Dr. Rich Rhoda and Dr. Jill Channing's Spring 2024 Weekend Seminar I for the Certificate in Community College Leadership Program at East Tennessee State University.
- Dell, M.* (2023, November 29). *The Tennessee Coaching Project*. Guest lecture delivered in Dr. Eric Bettinger's Experimental Research Design and Analysis (EDUC 430A) class at Stanford University.
- Dell, M.*, & Monday, A. (2022, June 29). *Estimating the impact of PLUS loan policy changes on historically Black colleges and universities*. Paper presented at the University of Zurich's PhD Discussion Workshop: Personnel Economics and Economics of Education in Laax, Switzerland.

Conference Presentations (details available upon request; * indicates presentations I gave)

2026: COPE;* LEER;* ifo Workshop in Dresden; IAB HELM;* SASE;* Third International Leading House Conference;* AOM (poster);* AQMAPPS;* SREE; Leading House on Tour at the Institute for Employment Research*
2025: AOM;* Leading House on Tour at the London School of Economics;* VET Workshop at the University of Bergamo*
2024: DREAM;* AEFPP; TENNAIR;* Verein für Socialpolitik (German Economic Association); SREE; TBR Advising Academy;* APPAM
2023: DRUID; SASE; NACADA;* TBR Advising Academy*
2022: COPE; AEFPP;* APPAM; First International Leading House Conference*
2021: AEFPP*
2020: APPAM*
2019: TENNAIR;* EPSOs in Action in Nashville;* APPAM (poster);* ASHE
2018: ASHE*
2017: College Promise Programs workshop at UPenn; ASHE (poster)*
2016: NSSR;* SACSCOC*

Research and Policy Reports (Not Peer-Reviewed)

Feygin, A., Miller, T., Bettinger, E., & **Dell, M.** (2022). *Advising for college success: A systematic review of the evidence*. College Completion Network.
<https://eric.ed.gov/?id=ED626933>.

Dell, M. (2021). *State authorization research: Findings, themes, and future directions*. State Higher Education Executive Officers Association. Report available [here](#).

Technical Skills

Statistical Software: Stata, R

Programming & Typesetting: LaTeX, SQL

Visualization: Power BI, Tableau

Qualitative Analysis & Survey Administration: QuestionPro, Dedoose

Service

Journal Referee: *Education Economics*, *Review of Educational Research*, *Journal of Student Financial Aid*

Associate Editor: AOM (2026, Public and Nonprofit Division)

Proposal Reviewer: SREE (2026); AOM (2026, Human Resources Division); DRUID (2023, 2025–2026); AERA (2020–2021); NCES Data Institute (2018–2020); ASHE (2018–2019)

Panelist: ASHE Graduate Student Policy Seminar (2023–2024)

Conference Roles: Leading House on Tour in Nuremberg (workshop organizer, 2026); Leading House on Tour in London (workshop organizer, 2025); COPE (session chair, 2025); Stanford GSE Student Conference (committee member, 2020); ASHE (session chair, 2018); We All Rise Conference (committee co-chair, 2018)